Conversation track 1, 3, 4

Hazel runs into her old classmate Owen at a farmers market.

Hazel: Owen? No way! I **haven't seen** you **since** graduation!

Owen: Hazel! Wow, it's been forever. How have you been?

Hazel: Great, thanks! I'm a nurse now. Are you still in Denver?

Owen: No, I moved to Seattle. **I've been** there **for** three years.

Hazel: Seattle? Nice! So what brings you back to town?

Owen: My sister's getting married on Saturday. **I've been** in town **since** Monday.

Hazel: Oh, how exciting! Tell her congratulations from me.

Owen: I will. Hey, let's grab coffee before I fly back!

Study Notes

It's been forever.
Lâu lắm rồi mới gặp lại!
Câu cảm thán khi gặp lại ai đó sau nhiều năm. "forever" ở đây là cách nói phóng đại, nghĩa là "rất, rất lâu".
Cách nói tương đương: It's been ages!

What brings you back to town?
Có việc gì mà bạn về lại đây thế?
"What brings you (here / to…)?" là cách hỏi thân thiện, lịch sự về lý do ai đó đến một nơi.
Cách nói tương đương: What are you doing back in town?

Speak Like a Native track 2

1. How have you been?
weak: "have", "you"
strong: "How", "been"
"have" đọc rất nhẹ, gần như chỉ còn âm /v/ dính vào "How": "haov-yơ-bin". Giọng Mỹ đọc "been" là /bɪn/ "bin", ngắn, không kéo dài.

2. I haven't seen you since graduation!
change: "haven't seen" (mất âm t)
strong: "haven't", "graduation"
Âm /t/ cuối của "haven't" gần như mất trước "seen": "he-vơn-sin". "graduation" nhấn vào âm "-a-" thứ hai: "gre-ju-Êl-shần".

3. I've been in town since Monday.
weak: "I've been"
linking: "been_in"
strong: "town", "Monday"
"I've" đọc /aɪv/; âm /v/ rất nhẹ nhưng đừng bỏ, vì "I been" là sai ngữ pháp. "been in" nối thành "bi-nin".

- "have / has" làm trợ động từ thường đọc nhẹ /həv/, /həz/, hoặc rút gọn: I've, she's.
- Giọng Mỹ đọc "been" là /bɪn/ "bin", kể cả khi được nhấn.
- Âm /t/ cuối của "haven't, hasn't" hay mất trước phụ âm: haven't seen → "he-vơn-sin".
- "for" đọc nhẹ /fər/; nhấn vào phần thời gian phía sau: for three YEARS, since MONday.

Grammar Focus

Hiện tại hoàn thành: have / has + V3

Nói về việc bắt đầu trong quá khứ và vẫn còn đến bây giờ. Phủ định: haven't / hasn't + V3. Khi nói thường rút gọn: I've, we've, she's.

I've known Lan since elementary school.
My dad **has worked** at the bank for twenty years.
She **hasn't called** me for two weeks.

for / since và câu hỏi How long…?

for + một khoảng thời gian (for two days, for ages); since + mốc bắt đầu (since Monday, since I was ten). Hỏi độ dài: How long have you…?

I've had this laptop **for** five years.
He's been sick **since** Friday.
How long have you lived here? – **Since** last spring.

Role Play track 6

A: Owen? No way! I haven't seen you since graduation!

B: Hazel! Wow, it's been forever. How have you been?

A: Great, thanks! I'm a nurse now. Are you still in Denver?

B: No, I moved to Seattle. I've been there _____.

A: Seattle? Nice! So what brings you back to town?

B: My sister's getting married on Saturday. I've been in town _____.

A: Oh, how exciting! Tell her congratulations from me.

B: I will. Hey, let's _____ before I fly back!

Substitution Drill track 7

1. I've been there **for three years**.
   a. for about a year
   b. since last summer
   c. since I changed jobs

2. I've been in town **since Monday**.
   a. since Thursday night
   b. for a few days
   c. for almost a week

3. Hey, let's **grab coffee** before I fly back!
   a. have lunch
   b. get dinner
   c. catch up properly